

SENATE BILL 904

By Lamar

AN ACT to amend Tennessee Code Annotated, Title 33
and Title 38, relative to alternative crisis response
units.

BE IT ENACTED BY THE GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE:

SECTION 1. Tennessee Code Annotated, Section 38-8-101, is amended by adding the following as new subdivisions:

() "Alternative crisis response unit" means a program where a qualified mental health professional, who is employed by a law enforcement agency, accompanies a full-time police officer on mental-health related calls for service, and the qualified mental health professional is considered the lead on the call;

() "Qualified mental health professional" means the same as defined in § 33-1-101;

SECTION 2. Tennessee Code Annotated, Section 38-8-104, is amended by adding the following as a new subsection:

(h) The commission shall establish uniform training standards for alternative crisis response units for all law enforcement agencies.

SECTION 3. Tennessee Code Annotated, Section 38-8-119, is amended by designating the existing language as subsection (a) and adding the following as a new subsection (b):

(b) The commission shall annually provide full-time police officers with training on how to best support a qualified mental health professional to a call for service with the alternative crisis response unit.

SECTION 4. Tennessee Code Annotated, Title 38, Chapter 8, Part 1, is amended by adding the following as a new section:

By January 1, 2026, each law enforcement agency shall develop and implement an alternative crisis response unit.

SECTION 5. Section 2 takes effect upon becoming a law, the public welfare requiring it.
All remaining sections take effect January 1, 2026, the public welfare requiring it.